



CAREERSENSE ACADEMY

Business Development & B2B Sales

ICP, prospecting, outreach, discovery, proposals, CRM pipelines, objections, partnerships, and closing

PARTNER LEARNING SERIES

Learn how professional business development creates qualified opportunities, builds trust, discovers real needs, and turns conversations into measurable partnerships.

CareerSense Partners • founders • sales beginners • account managers • marketers

CareerSense Learning Series • careersenseai.com/resources

FRONT MATTER

How to Use This Handbook

Learn how professional business development creates qualified opportunities, builds trust, discovers real needs, and turns conversations into measurable partnerships.

What each chapter contains

Each chapter follows the same learning rhythm used across the CareerSense Academy series: a concise introduction, learning objectives, plain-English concepts, CareerSense examples, professional habits, common mistakes, quick revision notes, practice questions, and hands-on exercises.

PARTNER PROMISE The examples are designed to prepare you for real CareerSense Partner assignments. Do not memorize terminology. Learn to create useful work products: audits, reports, prototypes, dashboards, campaigns, strategies, and decisions.

Recommended practice approach

- Read the relevant chapter before starting the matching Partner assignment.
- Use CareerSense or a safe sample environment to practise whenever possible.
- Keep evidence: screenshots, notes, links, spreadsheets, queries, designs, or metrics.
- Document assumptions and limitations instead of hiding uncertainty.
- Finish each chapter by completing at least one hands-on exercise.

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What You Will Learn

Chapter	Topic
01	B2B Fundamentals and Ideal Customer Profile
02	Prospecting and Account Research
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05	Value Proposals and Demos
06	Objections, Negotiation, and Follow-Up
07	CRM, Pipeline, and Forecasting
08	CareerSense Capstone: Enterprise Bridge

Closing the book: quick revision sheet • glossary • professional habits • 20-question quiz • answer key • next steps.

CHAPTER 01

01

B2B Fundamentals and Ideal Customer Profile

B2B selling is a process of helping an organization decide whether a solution meaningfully improves an outcome worth paying or committing resources for.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Define B2B sales
- Create an ICP
- Identify buying roles
- Understand business value

Core idea

B2B selling is a process of helping an organization decide whether a solution meaningfully improves an outcome worth paying or committing resources for.

Professional perspective

An ICP describes organizations most likely to have the problem, urgency, budget, authority, and fit.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

CareerSense may have different ICPs for universities, employers, training organizations, and campus programs.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Define B2B sales.
- Create an ICP.
- Identify buying roles.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of b2b fundamentals and ideal customer profile?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to b2b fundamentals and ideal customer profile using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 02

02

Prospecting and Account Research

High-quality prospecting starts before outreach. Research the organization, role, initiatives, likely challenges, and relevant evidence.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Build account lists
- Find relevant stakeholders
- Research triggers
- Prioritize accounts

Core idea

High-quality prospecting starts before outreach. Research the organization, role, initiatives, likely challenges, and relevant evidence.

Professional perspective

Avoid mass lists without prioritization.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

For university outreach, identify placement heads, career services, employability initiatives, student size, and upcoming placement cycles.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Build account lists.
- Find relevant stakeholders.
- Research triggers.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of prospecting and account research?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to prospecting and account research using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 03

03

Outbound Messaging

Good outreach answers: why this person, why now, what problem, what proof, and what low-friction next step.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Write concise outreach
- Personalize with relevance
- Create multistep sequences
- Use ethical follow-up

Core idea

Good outreach answers: why this person, why now, what problem, what proof, and what low-friction next step.

Professional perspective

Personalization should reflect real research, not superficial name insertion.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

A CareerSense university email should connect to employability outcomes, not simply list product features.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Write concise outreach.
- Personalize with relevance.
- Create multistep sequences.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of outbound messaging?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to outbound messaging using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 04

04

Discovery Calls

Discovery is not a product demo. It is a structured conversation to understand goals, current state, pain, impact, stakeholders, timing, and decision process.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Ask diagnostic questions
- Understand current process
- Quantify impact
- Identify decision criteria

Core idea

Discovery is not a product demo. It is a structured conversation to understand goals, current state, pain, impact, stakeholders, timing, and decision process.

Professional perspective

Questions should move from context to consequences and desired outcomes.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Ask a placement team how students currently prepare, where the process breaks, how they measure readiness, and what implementation constraints exist.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Ask diagnostic questions.
- Understand current process.
- Quantify impact.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of discovery calls?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to discovery calls using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 05

05

Value Proposals and Demos

A strong demo follows the buyer's workflow and priorities rather than presenting every feature.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Map needs to value
- Build outcome-focused demos
- Write proposals
- Define pilots

Core idea

A strong demo follows the buyer's workflow and priorities rather than presenting every feature.

Professional perspective

Proposals should summarize context, objectives, solution, scope, responsibilities, timeline, success measures, and commercials where applicable.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

A CareerSense pilot proposal can define a student cohort, services included, onboarding, reporting, and measurable readiness outcomes.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Map needs to value.
- Build outcome-focused demos.
- Write proposals.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of value proposals and demos?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to value proposals and demos using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 06

06

Objections, Negotiation, and Follow-Up

Objections often reveal missing information, risk, timing, trust, or priority issues. Explore before responding.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Handle objections
- Separate concern from rejection
- Negotiate responsibly
- Maintain momentum

Core idea

Objections often reveal missing information, risk, timing, trust, or priority issues. Explore before responding.

Professional perspective

Follow-up should add clarity or value rather than repeatedly asking for status.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

If a college says 'students already use free tools', explore fragmentation, verification, reporting, and institutional visibility.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Handle objections.
- Separate concern from rejection.
- Negotiate responsibly.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of objections, negotiation, and follow-up?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to objections, negotiation, and follow-up using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 07

07

CRM, Pipeline, and Forecasting

A CRM should tell the team what happened, what matters next, who owns it, and how likely the opportunity is.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Define sales stages
- Track next actions
- Measure conversion
- Forecast conservatively

Core idea

A CRM should tell the team what happened, what matters next, who owns it, and how likely the opportunity is.

Professional perspective

Stages should have entry and exit criteria rather than subjective labels.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

CareerSense partners can track researched, contacted, replied, meeting, pilot proposed, approved, launched, and expanded.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Define sales stages.
- Track next actions.
- Measure conversion.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of crm, pipeline, and forecasting?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to crm, pipeline, and forecasting using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 08

08

CareerSense Capstone: Enterprise Bridge

Research 20 organizations, identify relevant decision makers, create an outreach sequence, discovery guide, one-page proposal, and CRM pipeline.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Research target accounts
- Create outreach sequences
- Build a pitch
- Manage a sample pipeline

Core idea

Research 20 organizations, identify relevant decision makers, create an outreach sequence, discovery guide, one-page proposal, and CRM pipeline.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Deliver the account database, messaging, pitch, and lessons learned.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Research target accounts.
- Create outreach sequences.
- Build a pitch.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of careersense capstone: enterprise bridge?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to careersense capstone: enterprise bridge using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CLOSING THE BOOK

Course Summary

You have worked through the professional foundations of business development & b2b sales. The purpose of this handbook is not to make you fluent in vocabulary; it is to help you complete real work with stronger judgment, structure, evidence, and communication.

**PROFESSIONAL
TAKEAWAY**

CareerSense Partners should be able to explain not only what they did, but why it mattered, what evidence supported it, what trade-offs existed, and what measurable action should happen next.

Business Development & B2B Sales - Quick Revision Sheet

Topic	Remember
B2B Fundamentals and Ideal Customer Profile	Define B2B sales
Prospecting and Account Research	Build account lists
Outbound Messaging	Write concise outreach
Discovery Calls	Ask diagnostic questions
Value Proposals and Demos	Map needs to value
Objections, Negotiation, and Follow-Up	Handle objections
CRM, Pipeline, and Forecasting	Define sales stages
CareerSense Capstone: Enterprise Bridge	Research target accounts

Glossary

Term	Plain-English meaning
Pipeline	A structured view of sales opportunities by stage.
Discovery	Conversation used to understand goals, pain, impact, and decision process.
Proposal	Document outlining context, solution, scope, value, and terms.
Outcome	A measurable change in user, customer, or business behavior.
Metric	A quantitative measure used to monitor performance or progress.
Hypothesis	A testable statement about what change is expected and why.
Stakeholder	A person or group affected by or able to influence an initiative.
MVP	The smallest trustworthy version that tests an important assumption.
KPI	A key performance indicator tied to an important objective.
Iteration	A cycle of building, measuring, learning, and improving.
Trade-off	Choosing one benefit or priority while accepting a cost elsewhere.
Evidence	Observed information that supports or challenges a decision.
Prioritization	Deciding what deserves attention and resources first.

20-Question Practice Quiz

1. What is one core principle from 'B2B Fundamentals and Ideal Customer Profile'?
9. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'B2B Fundamentals and Ideal Customer Profile' in a real assignment?
2. What is one core principle from 'Prospecting and Account Research'?
10. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Prospecting and Account Research' in a real assignment?
3. What is one core principle from 'Outbound Messaging'?
11. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Outbound Messaging' in a real assignment?
4. What is one core principle from 'Discovery Calls'?
12. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Discovery Calls' in a real assignment?
5. What is one core principle from 'Value Proposals and Demos'?
13. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Value Proposals and Demos' in a real assignment?
6. What is one core principle from 'Objections, Negotiation, and Follow-Up'?
14. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Objections, Negotiation, and Follow-Up' in a real assignment?
7. What is one core principle from 'CRM, Pipeline, and Forecasting'?
15. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'CRM, Pipeline, and Forecasting' in a real assignment?
8. What is one core principle from 'CareerSense Capstone: Enterprise Bridge'?
16. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'CareerSense Capstone: Enterprise Bridge' in a real assignment?
17. Why should recommendations be tied to evidence?
18. What is the difference between an activity and an outcome?
19. Why should assumptions and limitations be documented?
20. What makes an assignment deliverable useful to leadership?

Answer Key

1. A strong answer should explain define b2b sales and connect it to an observable decision or result.
9. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
2. A strong answer should explain build account lists and connect it to an observable decision or result.
10. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
3. A strong answer should explain write concise outreach and connect it to an observable decision or result.
11. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
4. A strong answer should explain ask diagnostic questions and connect it to an observable decision or result.
12. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
5. A strong answer should explain map needs to value and connect it to an observable decision or result.
13. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
6. A strong answer should explain handle objections and connect it to an observable decision or result.
14. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
7. A strong answer should explain define sales stages and connect it to an observable decision or result.
15. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
8. A strong answer should explain research target accounts and connect it to an observable decision or result.
16. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
17. Evidence separates a useful recommendation from an unsupported opinion.
18. An activity is work performed; an outcome is the change produced by that work.
19. Documenting assumptions makes uncertainty visible and allows reviewers to judge the strength of the conclusion.
20. A useful deliverable is clear, evidence-based, actionable, appropriately scoped, and tied to an owner or next decision.

CAREERSENSE ACADEMY

Keep Building

You now have a working foundation in business development & b2b sales. Use this handbook as a reference before and during your Partner assignments. Professional capability grows when you repeatedly turn concepts into useful outputs, receive feedback, and improve your judgment.

NEXT STEPS

- Choose the CareerSense Partner assignment most closely related to this handbook.
- Review the relevant chapter before beginning.
- Complete the assignment with traceable evidence.
- Ask for feedback on both the result and your decision process.
- Add the finished work to your Partner portfolio where permitted.

**CAREERSENSE
PARTNER
LEARNING PATH**

Learn → Apply → Document → Review → Improve → Lead.

More CareerSense learning resources

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